



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

**AHOC Members Chris Komor and Patrick Townshend
Racing in Queensland - Photos by Pete Trapnell**



AHOC members Chris Komor (100) and Patrick Townshend (3000 Mk1) competed in their Austin-Healeys in the Shannons Historic Racing and Classic Car Festival over 14-16 July at Queensland Raceway, near Ipswich.

Organised by the Historic Racing Car Club of Queensland, the meeting attracted close to 150 entrants from as far afield as Western Australia.

Both Chris and Patrick ran in Group Sa - production sports

cars, January 1941 and 31st December 1960. Patrick won best in the group and set a new class lap record.

Patrick received congratulations as with his tow car being out of action, he drove from Sydney to the circuit, raced for three days, and then drove back.

Chris comments that the competition bar in our Club has been raised considerably. Patrick's brother Becher, driving the ex-Brian Duffy 100/6 will no doubt add to the excitement in future events.



VOL. 10 ISSUE
Aug 2023

#8

COMING EVENTS

AUGUST

3rd Monthly Meeting
5th Cent Coast W'shop
9th JindyAndy Grain Mill
9th Committee Meeting
19th Mid-Nth Coast W'shop
20th Cent West at Swap Meet
27th Cherry Blossom Festival

SEPTEMBER

2nd Cent Coast Workshop
4-8th Painted Silos Tour
7th Monthly Meeting
13th Committee Meeting
17th All British Day

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Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

We're now more than halfway through winter and I for one will be happy to see the back of it. Unfortunately, or perhaps fortunately, I will not be at the August meeting, but will attempt to join you from Flowerpot Tasmania via Zoom and I expect that it will get colder. Many thanks to John Wakeling who is again stepping in to assist with the technical aspects and to "Have I got a deal for you" Colin Rule to keep the meeting in order.

My Austin-Healey takes just that much longer to get to operating temperature these mornings, and as I don't have a choke that you can set, it requires a bit of manual dexterity to hold the choke out, change gear and turn the steering wheel all at the same time. However, the cold wind across the face with the occasional rain thrown in, makes you appreciate the joys of driving your Austin-Healey when the weather is warmer. So, my



suggestion to all you owners who leave their Austin-Healey under cover when the weather is cold, take it out of the garage in winter and you will really appreciate the experience of driving when it's warm and dry.

It was such a cold morning as described that I attended Terry Bancroft's funeral. With top-down, Colin Rule and myself reckoned that we were going on one of Terry's Brass Monkey Runs as it certainly felt like it.

Terry's funeral was a beautiful ceremony when many of his col-

leagues got together to bid farewell. You will find a report in this issue of Flat Chat. A work colleague always used to say that you should always attend a funeral, and I have found that to be good advice as you get to hear about the other side of a person's life that you are completely unaware of, and it was no different with Terry's. For a limited time, you are still able to view it on Terry's funeral Service (see page 4) and I would encourage you to do so and learn of some of the achievements that he was able to accomplish.

Cont' Page 6

COMMITTEE LIST - 2023

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Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirtion
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Alan Jones (D),
Warwick Sell (D), Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick
Quinn, Terry Bancroft (D), Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the
Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
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Greetings and welcome to the August 2023 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter and this issue once again asks the question "Why is it so?".

Why does it all go past so quickly? I recall when younger when Sundays really dragged as the time went so slowly. I am always reminded of a Hancock's Half Hour episode titled Sunday Afternoon at Home, where he was bored and miserable at home looking for something to do on a wet Sunday afternoon. I remember being bored on a Sunday and waiting for it all to pass. Then I bought an Austin-Healey and 'bored' has long left my vocabulary.

So what I am getting to is that this issue is a little light on, as the elusive and fluid commodity called time slips past unbelievably quickly. I have just over an hour to finish this issue and then get it away to President Jim who is currently sunning himself with Bill and Ben in Flowerpot, Tasmania. I have content that hasn't been used yet, so my apologies to those who sent it in.

However there still is quite a bit of content within the issue that you will find interesting. There are reports of the Central Coast workshop and the visit to the site of the growing Nancy-Bird Walton Airport at Badgerys Creek, followed by a memory inducing visit to a local hostelry.

As usual I am indebted to a number of members for sending in material for us all to enjoy. Such as we wouldn't have known about the exploits of Chris Komor and Patrick Townshend who took their cars to Queensland Raceway for a few days of enjoyable motorsport. You would have seen the photos and words on the cover.

Thanks again to Ian Richter for the latest snippet instalment on the restoration of his BN1. Thank you too to Chris Hatch who crossed his heart at a recent Mid-North Coast Chapter gathering promising he would send words on multimeters. Thanks Chris. Perhaps one day you can sit down with me and explain what the machine sitting in its box really does.

Then there are some words and photos from the funeral of our recently passed life member Terry Bancroft.



After putting it off for some time I have finally got stuck into giving the Quinn Austin-Healey steering wheel what's for. I had around half a dozen small cracks in the Bakelite that needed filling. So armed with a Dremel type of tool I gouged out some offending material in preparation to filling it with some epoxy two pack stuff. That's where I'm up to as then I had to wait three or four days until it had hardened enough to rub back. After that it will be painted with some epoxy two-pack semi-gloss black. Well, that's the plan anyway. More next month. In the meantime there is a cast iron fountain from which to remove the rust and a whole lot of timber decking that has succumbed to rot. See I told you that I started being busy from when I bought my first Austin-Healey in 1972.

I trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter. Please if you are doing some work to your car or taking it for an enjoyable run, let your fellow members know by sending in a few words and perhaps a photo or two relevant to the story. I'm sure it's time better spent on a Sunday afternoon than watching TV.



Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club

Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm

Farewell Terry

and thanks for all the green frogs
by Parick Quinn

At every Brass Monkey Run, no matter how cold it was, Terry Bancroft made sure there were plenty of green frogs for everyone when they arrived at the destination. Green frogs were Terry's favourite confectionary.

Green frogs were available for everyone on Wednesday 12 July 2023 when we all said farewell to Terry at the Pinegrove Memorial Park at Minchinbury. As we walked into the chapel the White Ladies made sure there were bowls of them, with each green frog providing a memory.

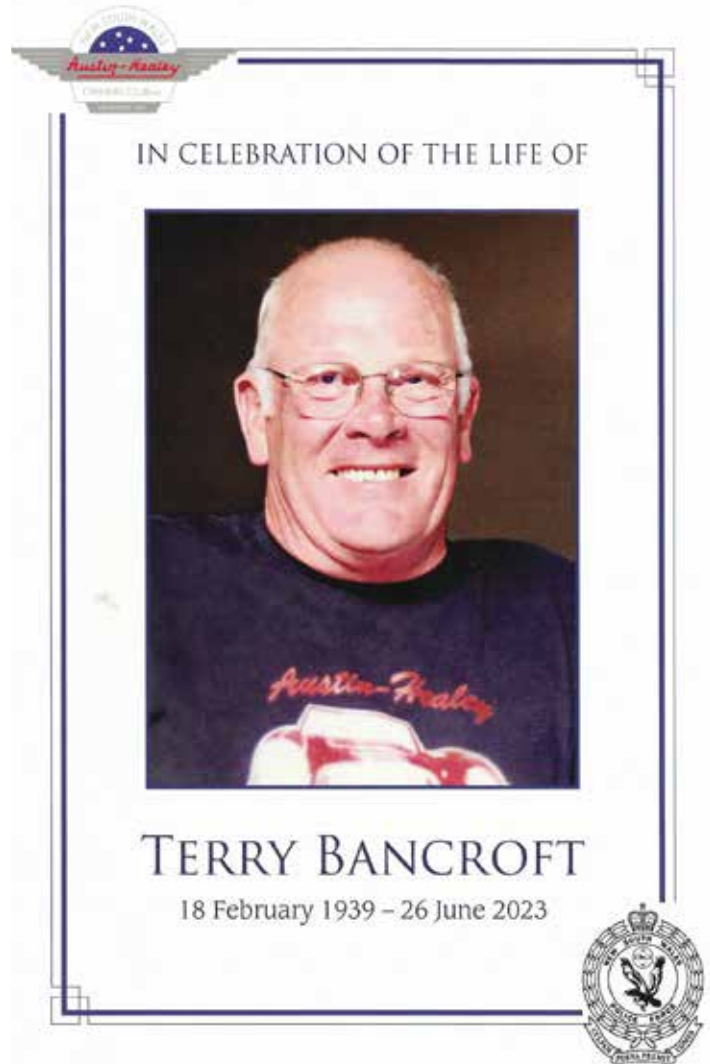
The chapel entrance was lined with serving police officers' guard of honour showing respect for the loss of one of their own. The chapel itself was full to overflowing with Terry's family, colleagues and friends including a very large number of Austin-Healey owners. While the occasion was a sad one, it was lovely to see so many past and present members of the AHOC. Those not seen for some time included John and Jill Dowsett, Ernie and Merle Clark, John and Carolyn Kent, Ken Button, Don Read, Dave Mould, Bob Cutler, Graham Bouquet and many more who I no doubt missed.

President Jim is correct, where he says on page 2 "Terry's funeral was a beautiful ceremony when many of his colleagues got together to bid farewell."

The service was ably led by ex-police colleague turned celebrant Brett O'Brien who introduced daughter Trish Bancroft who spoke on behalf of the family, followed on behalf of the grandchildren by granddaughter Harri Bancroft. I was honoured to be asked to speak about Terry and Pat's Austin-Healey ownership and their 40 plus year relationship with the AHOC.

As is the custom today, the service was recorded and is still available to be seen at:

<https://view.oneroomstreaming.com/index.php?-data=MTY4ODA1NzY1MzExNzIwNzUmb25lcm-9vbS1lbWFpbnZpdGF0aW9uX2NvcHlfbGlu-aw==>



The service was punctuated throughout by some of Terry's favourite musical pieces and on closing those present were invited to sign Terry's last Healey. At the end everyone was asked to "Enjoy one of Terry's favourite green frogs as you leave." I did of course, but I noticed some red ones as well.

Following, everyone was invited to coffee, tea, sandwiches, cakes and more green frogs within Pinegrove Memorial Park where we all had the chance to have a chinwag and exchange memories with friends. Also, very pleasing to see the number of Austin-Healeys brought along for the service including the Bancroft family's BT7 Mk2 and BJ8.

We will miss him and again condolences to Patricia and family.

More photos next page



**Terry's Last
Healey**



The Bancroft Mk2 Roadster



Ronnie Strange in his Mk2 Roadster



Jim Phillips and Colin Rule in Jim's BN4.



**Muriel Roberts and grandson Josh House
and the Robert's BJ8 with the BJ7 of Stu-
art and Diana McColl.**



**The BJ7 of Pamela and Doug Ross with Dave Mould
alongside in his Mk2 BN7.**



**Unknown Mk2 Roadster,
Darryl Dobe's 100 with
Larry and Helen Johns in
their Mk1 BT7.**

Austin-Healeys at the Men's Shed

By Jim Phillips

A couple of weeks ago Erina's Men Shed opened its roller doors with invitations to the other men's sheds on the Central Coast and the public to join them for morning tea, a church service, an inspection of the premises, plus a barbeque lunch.

Included was a car display to which some of our local members showed off their Austin-Healeys along

with cars from the Coast Community Car Club. Colin Rule, Scott Parry-Jones, Doug Ross, Larry Johns, Adam Lethlean and Jim Phillips represented the AHOC.

The vehicles gained a lot of attention particularly from the preschoolers who attend the school that is part of the property.



Pres Message cont'

At the last committee meeting it was agreed that members would be able to pay fees for up to three years in advance. No! there is not going to be any reduction in the cost, but you won't have to pay any extra if the fees go up.

Lastly, a topic that all members find almost as riveting as reading the minutes is the club's constitution. One of the tasks that I've set myself while in the Apple Isle is to rewrite our constitution. We need to bring it into line with the model constitution that is set out by Fair Trading NSW. As the constitution represents the rule book for the operation of our club, it is important that members are in agreement with the rules. Well at least the majority of members.

When the review has been completed it will be distributed to all members and then agreed by a special resolution at one of our meetings. If there is anything in the current constitution that you believe needs to be changed this will be your opportunity to have that considered. Please let me know now so that this can be addressed and not when it gets to the stage of being agreed by the membership.

See you on Zoom.

ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

Jim Phillips
President

Perhaps you have a set of engine pipes or down pipes for a six-cylinder in your garage just taking up space. Would you like to get rid of them? If so Neville Stirton is looking for a set that are in unserviceable condition that he could use to have a new set made from. If you have please give Neville a call on 0414 472 877.

Membership Report

by Christine Lyttle - membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Did you forget to pay??

Your membership fees are now OVERDUE!



This will be your last Flat Chat!

Have you forgotten your membership expired on 30 June 2023? Should you wish to maintain your membership you **NEED TO PAY THE FEES NOW – \$100 to the club bank account - details are BSB 032-669 Account 252564 and put your surname in the description – if only able to input numbers then put your membership number or postcode and email me to advise your payment was made**

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

We still have **39 memberships outstanding**, some are on Conditional Registration. Remember as you are no longer a member, your car is no longer registered, unless you have joined another club and have advised Transport for NSW. You should not drive your Conditionally Registered car if you are not financial. We look forward to receiving your payment shortly.

Reminders have been sent to all.

A further reminder your car details can be updated by you on the website, please log on to the website and update them. We need to ensure that we utilise our website rather than keeping alternative registers as these all take time to update.

Membership cards will be available online from the website shortly. We are still working on this and expect this feature will be available very soon.

We will also have an online membership form available on the website shortly for new memberships. Note you do not need to complete a membership form for a renewal, the form is for new applications.

No new members this month. We do have a few prospective members that I am awaiting their applications and payment.

We will be introducing a three-year membership if members are interested to pay in advance.

We will be having the General Meeting as another hybrid this month, so if you are not able to attend, perhaps logon to your computer, iPad or phone and join in on the ZOOM in. ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

I will be taking a holiday break and will not be attending the September meeting, though will keep in touch via email and hopefully will have some new members to report.

Look forward to seeing you all at an event soon.

Happy Healeying
Christine Lyttle



Social Report

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deniskasza@gmail.com

July has proved to be a busy and interesting month. Donald Healey's birthday celebrated in style with rows of delicious curves, sensational design, beautiful colours and rapturous engine notes that rival most orchestras. Elements were reported in the last Flat Chat.

The "Break-out Tour" led by John Thornton, revealing the new Badgerys Creek Airport had good member participation, with people coming from across the Sydney Basin, Illawarra and beyond.

The complete month was perfect for top-down cruising, putting the finishing touches to Austin-Healey's for spring/summer cruising and the very first All British Day since 2019.

The creation of chapters that allow AHOC members to engage and meet in localities without having to travel huge distances are gaining traction. As we move from winter to spring/summer, participation and friendships will grow. It is really encouraging to see the growth of each event, with most having 20-30 members attend each event and more.

There are lots of individuals behind creating these events, ensuring members can get together on a regular basis, enjoying their cars and the company of people with similar interests. To ensure there are events each and every month Colin Rule, Denis Kasca, John Thornton, Greg Poole, Phil Lorking, Neville Stirton and Patrick Quinn are making sure we are connected and engaged in greater numbers with lots of varying activities. Greater numbers at each event, generate greater participation and better outcomes for all.

July Chapter Events

For information on the July Chapter Events see starting on page 10.

Future Events

Central Coast Chapter plus Sydney Members

Saturday 5th August 2023 (1st Saturday Each Month): Technical Workshop & Meet
 Address: 109 Humphreys Road South Kincumber
 9:15 AM – 12:00 PM
 (NO NEED TO REGISTER)
 Please bring a contribution to morning tea

Following on from the technical meet will be a run to Patonga taking in many of the Central Coast's picturesque beaches to the Patonga Beach Club. If you cannot make the technical workshop, but would like to be part of the drive and lunch at the Patonga Beach Club please be at the Rule residence by 10:45 am for an 11am departure.

AHOC Illawarra and Southern Highlands Chapters

Wednesday 9th August 2023: JindyAndy Grain Mill
 11:00 AM
 719 Greenwell Point Road Pyree NSW
 See page 13 for more details

Mid North Coast Chapter

Saturday 19th August 2023 (3rd Saturday Each Month): Technical Workshop & Meet
 Address: 79 Barton Street Croki
 Saturday 19th August 2023.
 9:00 AM – 12:00 PM (Please register in advance)
 Phil Lorking 0412 392 3620 thelorkings@outlook.com.au or Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
 Please bring a contribution to morning tea

Central West Chapter

Sunday 20th August 2023: Bathurst Historic Car Club 34th Annual Swap Meet
 Mountain Straight Bathurst, Mount Panorama Racing Circuit
 6:00 AM – 3:00 PM Meet 10:00 AM Entrance to Museum (Please register in advance)
 Greg Poole 0403 839 482 or Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493

Please note this is an event where people need to register in advance. If numbers are not met, the event will be cancelled and only those registered will be advised.

All Members Welcome – Spring Cherry Blossom Celebration

Sunday 27th August 2023

Address: Auburn Botanical Gardens, Corner of Chisholm & Chiswick Streets, Auburn
11:00 AM – 3:00 PM

The Japanese Cherry Blossom Festival is globally famous, celebrated around the world, with images and tourist numbers swelling into the millions for the Festival which generally last five days.

If you have not learnt to speak Japanese, yet long to see the Cherry Blossom, the best alternative is at the Auburn Botanic Gardens.

As with All British Day the festival has been on hiatus for some years and expectations for participation are huge.

For residents of Auburn local council tickets are free. To others there is a small cost. Given tickets are timed it is suggested if you wish to attend you go online book tickets and we will coordinate member participation and meeting point the week before. See page 16.

Painted Silos Run

4th – 8th September

It is no surprise that the Painted Silos Tour created by Terry Bancroft has had a tremendous volume of participation. In honour of Terry, the Painted Silos tour will proceed.

Most aspects of the tour have been confirmed and booked. If you intend to participate in the tour and have not booked please advise Neville Stirton 0414 472 877 or Denis Kasza 0407 492 008. Neville Stirton has advised that while motel accommodation has been booked in the name of the Austin-Healey Owners Club it is necessary for attendees to contact the motels with their details and that they are part of the AHOC booking.

All British Day

Sunday 17th September 2023

Address: Kings School Parramatta
8:30 AM – 3:00 PM

There are still tickets to display available.

Last run in 2019, the All British Day will be held again on 17 September 2023. Over the last three years there have been many new Austin-Healeys added to the club register, and likewise many that have been upgraded, revitalised, painted and more.

If you intend to show your Austin-Healey at the All British Day there are a limited number of tickets which will be allocated on a first come first served basis. Please email bruce.ewan1@gmail.com to register interest as a display car.



The August meeting is scheduled for 7.30pm Thursday the 3rd at Strathfield Golf Club Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Come along from 5.30pm and enjoy dinner in the bistro with your fellow club members. Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

Chapter News



Central Coast Chapter - 1st July

The good weather was with us once again. A beautiful sunny Saturday morning, ready for another Central Coast Chapter Workshop. We had a total of 12 attendees with eight Austin-Healeys, including a BN2 still on the hoist under wraps and two Sunbeam Alpines.

The theme for the morning was to detail our cars for the Donald Healey Birthday Display Day to be held the next day. The only trouble was, they all turned up sparkling clean. One might say, mission accomplished.

I might add the Donald Healey Birthday Display Day was a wonderful day. Clear blue skies, lots and lots of very clean Austin-Healeys and associated marques, plus a great barbecue lunch.

So our Workshop morning turned into a very long coffee, cookies and cake. This gave us a lovely opportunity to catch up with one another and also welcome some newbies to our workshop. Our newly invited guests were Mark and Janet Kertly from Bensville, just down the road. They arrived in a beautifully restored red Sunbeam Alpine. We also had the opportunity to admire Geoff Smith's handiwork in engine building. The newly rebuilt BJ8 engine belonging to HBJ8L/27342, (The next cab off the rank).

Attendees for the day were, Ian Richter, Adam Lethlean and Helen Vance 3000 BN7 MK1, Geoff Smith 3000 BT7 MK1, Jim Phillips 100/6 BN4, Julie and Garry Lee 3000 BJ8 and Kerrie and Col Rule the Bond Austin-Healey 3000. And the Sunbeam Alpines of Richard Cardew and Mark and Janet Kertly.

Just to let you know the August Saturday Morning Workshop will be held on the 5th at 109 Humphreys Road Kincumber South. Our Sydney Saturday morning workshop attendees will be joining us here on the Central Coast. We will be having a very interesting talk by Kathleen Long giving us a history lesson on the Repco Spare Parts Company, including the Repco Brabham V8 engine.

You are all invited to what promises to be a very interesting morning indeed. Don't forget to bring some cookies and cake to share, coffee and tea will be on tap as usual.

We plan to finish the workshop around 11 am and then all driving over to our beautiful Patonga Beach for a causal lunch at The Boathouse Hotel, taking in some magnificent scenic views along the way.

All you have to do is turn up!! Take care and Happy Healeying. Col and Kerrie Rule.



AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

"The Break-out Tour" REPORT

It was a beautiful fine sunny day on Wednesday 19 July for our "Break Out" trip to the Western Sydney International (Nancy-Bird Walton) Airport.

Fran and I drove out along Elizabeth Drive to get to our destination. Boy!! What a change has taken place to all the locations along the Drive. The works extend from Luddenham to Kemps Creek. Massive earth works, new intersection flyovers being built and activity everywhere. A huge undertaking, heading to a 2026 commissioning.

Our members and invited guests met at the purpose-built Experience Centre on the western end of

After our visit we moved onto the Wallacia Hotel for a country style pub lunch. It was a time for a 'memory lane' experience for some who were frequent visitors to the Silverdale Hillclimb in the '70s.

Rob and Annie Sassall arrived in their BT7 with David McIntyre with his BJ8 and mate Charlie Cugaly. Other members and guests on the "Tour" included Joe Armour and brother Peter Armour, Patrick and Caroline Quinn, John and Judy Sherman, Ray and Murial Roberts, with John and Fran Thornton and friends Brian and Jackie Carnegie.



the site at Luddenham, off The Northern Road. The Experience Centre gave us a view over the whole site, with the runway directly in front of us and the Main Terminal under construction. The terminal is well advanced with the façade glazing being installed at this time. In the distance, all the associated works were on view.

The Experience Centre gave a visual presentation with a range of interactive and immersive displays providing extensive and detailed information about the Western Sydney International Airport.



The BN4 of Rob and Annie Sassall.



David McIntyre's BJ8.

Wallacia Memories

By Patrick Quinn

Thank you to John and Fran Thornton for arranging the visit to the Badgery's Creek Airport, although I look forward to when its proper name - Western Sydney International (Nancy-Bird Walton) Airport becomes universal parlance. The visit was truly interesting and informative.

However it was the following lunch venue that brought back the memories. As after we visited the future airport it was a 10 minute drive to the Wallacia Hotel where I had not been to since the first half of the 1970s.

Located just a quick drive from the hotel was Silverdale Hillclimb, where the AHOC frequently visited to take part in hillclimbs as part of the CSCA (Combined Sports Car Association) Championship. For some years we would win the CSCA Championship, through the weight of numbers.

It was the time when Ross Bond had recently sold his 3000 to AHOC president Ben Sellers, who would drive the car daily to work as well as competing in lap dashes and hillclimbs on the weekend. It was a very different motor car then compared to now. The magic best time up Silverdale was 40 seconds and for a period it was Ben against Morgan driver Bruce Callahan. They both bested the magic 40 secs on the same day and following the meeting we all retired to the Wallacia Hotel for some liquid reflections.

During the 1970s there was no hotel Sunday trading, but Wallacia was seen as being in the country and therefore hotels like the Wallacia Hotel would be open to bonafide travellers. Heading home from Silverdale, we were certainly bonafide travellers and what better place to stop?

The last time I recall being a bonafide traveller, was after a hillclimb when we were driving along the semi-paved

road when after being passed by a TR3 I acted like any mid-20s sports car driver and gave chase. Not long after the 100 sailed over a ridge and with a crash deposited all its oil on the road. However there was an element of good fortune, as in the 100's passenger seat was fellow club member Dennis Wraight who was a very competent mechanic. The other good fortune was that Brian Jones (brother of Alan Jones) came along in his Buckle Corolla and was persuaded to tow us to the service station almost opposite the Wallacia Hotel. A few weeks later Brian found that he had to rebuild the Toyota's engine.

At the service station Dennis managed to convince the proprietor that it was in his best interests to lend his welding gear. So after Dennis removed the sump and welded it, followed by me purchasing new oil we retired to across the road.

Maybe it was just me, but back then I thought the Wallacia Hotel had some charm and it was most enjoyable to sit on tables and chairs out the back scattered on lawn and in the sun. Today, while the front façade of the building continues to beckon, not so the built-up area out the back that's now raised, bricked and tables position to squeeze in as many patrons as possible. In my mind it has become very commercial.

Sadly Silverdale Hillclimb is long gone, but the memories are still there. However sometimes it's better not to revisit all past memories.

Sorry I have no photos of the '70s as the only camera I had at the time was a Box Brownie and mobiles as we know of them today didn't exist. However courtesy of AHOC honorary member Bob Cutler here is a photo of Bob running up the hill in his 100. Thanks Bob.



AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

JINDYANDY GRAIN MILL

Wednesday 9th August 2023

11:00am

719 Greenwell Point Road Pyree NSW (NOWRA)



Come and meet Fran and me at the JindyAndy Grain Mill at 11:00am where you can:

1. Fossick through the antiques and tools.
2. Search for clothing in The Mill Market Place.
3. Satisfy your sweet tooth at The Lolly Shop.
4. Buy gifts galore at The Gift Shops.
5. Purchase Knick-Knacks that you never knew you needed!
6. Relax at the Café for coffee, tea and cake or something more.

And then moving onto lunch:

Join us at the Pelican Rocks Seafood Restaurant at about 12:30pm:

117 Greenwell Point Road, Greenwell Point. About 30 minutes further along the road.

Please let me know you are coming.....no later than Thursday 4th August.

John Thornton

Mobile: 0419 266 284

Email: john.thornton2011@outlook.com



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

Lately a number of members have asked what's involved in placing their cars on Conditional Registration. Frankly if you don't have a vehicle on Conditional Registration it's understandable that you're not aware of what's involved so I thought it would be useful thing to lay it out.

It's really simple if you have a car on full registration in NSW or previously registered in NSW. You will need to fill in two forms that can be downloaded from the Transport for NSW website. These are:-

<https://www.nsw.gov.au/sites/default/files/2021-02/rms-form-45070939-conditional-reg.pdf>
and

<https://www.nsw.gov.au/sites/default/files/2021-02/rms-form-45070967-historic-vehicle-declaration.pdf>

The first is an application for Conditional Registration and the second is an Historic Vehicle Declaration. You fill in the Application and only the left column on the Declaration. As with all cars in NSW your vehicle needs to be inspected for roadworthiness. This can be by way of a pink slip or one of our two inspection officers can inspect it for you. See below for their contact details.

Send it all to me as below and once you receive it back, go to your closest Services NSW office and complete the transaction over the counter. The initial fee covers the admin fee, plate fee and CTP insurance. You do not pay any further fee including CTP. You will be handed a set of plates and a logbook to be completed every day you use your car, except for club events when there is no requirement to do so.

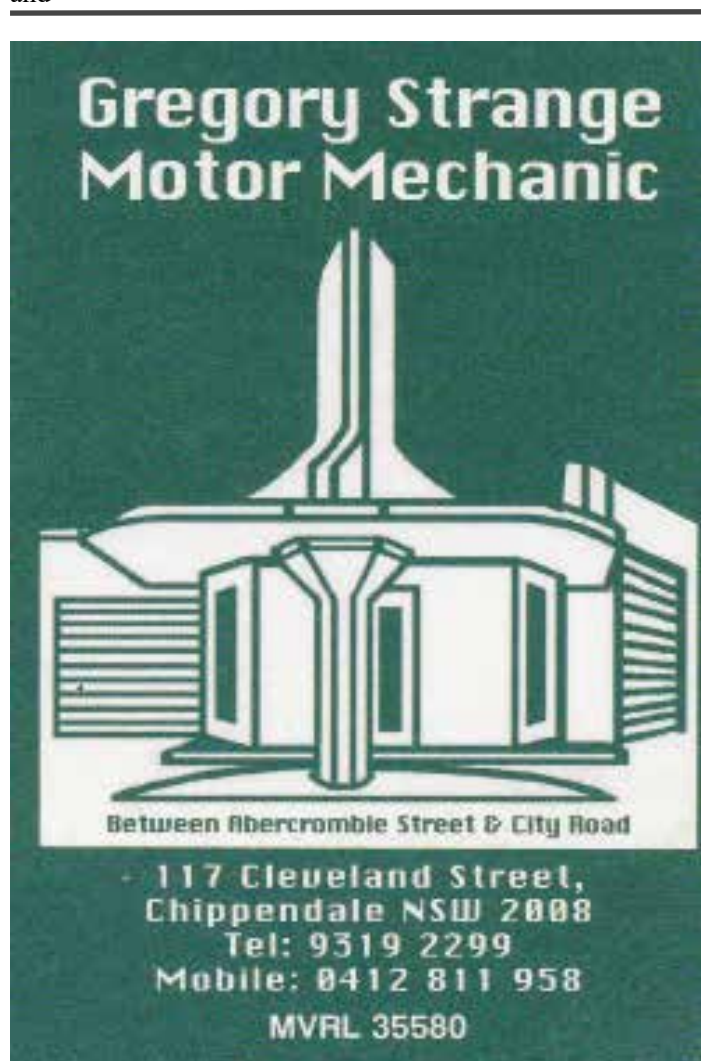
If your car is freshly restored or converted from left to right hand drive and has not been registered before in NSW you will need a blue slip in place of a pink slip. The rest of the process is the same.

Again, the necessary renewal steps are indicated below.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.

- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.

- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

What's in the AHOC.

By Patrick Quinn

Once again the Donald Healey Birthday Display Day was a delightful day held in warm winter sunshine.

In total there were 27 Austin-Healeys present at Parramatta Park, which was a reasonable number, however of this there were only three 100s in attendance. Of the three, two were BN2s and the third a 100M.

Is it another Austin-Healey 'Why is it So?' situation? Where are all the 100s?

So it caused me to look through the model numbers

within the AHOC just to see how many we have of each model. I last did this back in 2018 and while overall numbers haven't changed all that much, there have been some changes with cars coming/going interstate and overseas.

This is not an indication of marque cars in NSW, but only within the AHOC. There are a lot more cars in NSW that are **not** owned by AHOC members. It also doesn't include cars owned by members who are keeping quiet about them.

	2023	2018
Warwick Healeys	7	6
Warwick Austin-Healeys	3	3
100 BN1	45	47
100 BN2	11	12
100M	1	0
100/6 BN4	11	9
100/6 BN6	5	7
3000 Mk1 BT7	18	20
3000 Mk1 BN7	6	5
3000 Mk2 BT7	9	6
3000 Mk2 BN7	2	5
3000 Mk2 BJ7	14	17
3000 Mk3 BJ8	56	52
Sprite	7	5
Jensen-Healey	1	1
Total	196	195



Spot what's not an Austin-Healey

AUG
27



CHERRY BLOSSOM FEST

Sun 27 August 2023 11am
to 3pm
Auburn Botanical Gardens
Cnr Chisholm/ Chiswick
Sts Auburn
Tickets purchased online
Enq. Denis Kasza
0407492008

PAINTED SILOS TOUR - 4th to 8th September 2023 - Itinerary

Monday - SEPTEMBER 4th

Depart Sydney
Travel to HARDEN MURRUMBURRAH
Silo location – Neill Street, Harden

Continue to GRENFELL

Silo location – 30 West Street, Grenfell

Continue to WEST WYALONG for overnight stay at either:-

CAMEO MOTEL, 263 Neeld Street, \$120/night, 6 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2255

Or

COLONIAL MOTOR INN, 4 Ungarie Road, \$ 130/night, 10 rooms

Phone (02) 6972 2611

TOTAL 530 KMS FOR DAY



Grenfell



Harden



Weethallie

Tuesday - SEPTEMBER 5th

Depart West Wyalong to WEETHALLIE

Silo location – Railway Street, Weethallie

Continue travel on to DUBBO for overnight stay at

BLUE DIAMOND MOTOR INN, 113/115 Wingewarra Street, \$150/night, 10 Queen, 5 Twin rooms

Phone (02) 6882 0666

TOTAL 380 KMS FOR DAY



Dunedoo



Quirindi



Merriwa

Wednesday - SEPTEMBER 6th

Depart Dubbo to DUNEDOO

Silo location – Castlereagh Highway, Dunedoo

Continue to MERRIWA

Silo location – Hackets Road, Merriwa

Continue to QUIRINDI via SCONE

Silo location – Quirindi

Overnight stay at BEST WESTERN MOTEL/RSL, \$148/night, two people

Phone (02) 6746 1995

TOTAL 340 KMS FOR DAY



Barraba



Gunnedah

Thursday - SEPTEMBER 7th

Depart Quirindi to BARRABA,

Silo location – Manilla Road, Barraba

Continue travel to GUNNEDAH

Silo location – 2 Barber Street, Gunnedah

Overnight stay at the HARVEST LODGE MOTEL, 404 Conadilly Street, \$160 for night, 2 people

Phone: (02) 6742 3400

TOTAL 260 KM FOR DAY

Friday - SEPTEMBER 8th

Depart Gunnedah to PORTLAND

Silo location – William Street, Portland

NO MOTEL ORGANISED, SOME MAY WISH TO TRAVEL HOME.

IF NOT, BOOK A MOTEL

TOTAL 350 KMS FOR DAY TO PORTLAND



Portland

In memory of Terry Bancroft this event is proceeding.

If interested call Neville Stirton on 0414 472 877 or Denis Kasza on 0407 492 008.



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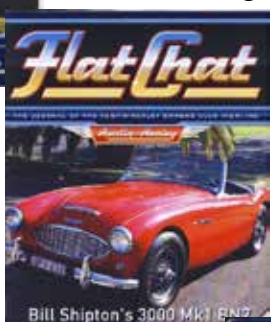
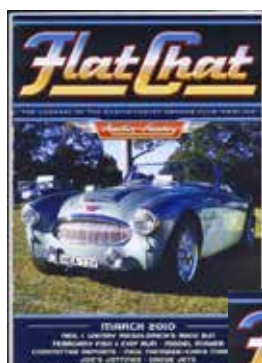
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along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



Maude - The BN1 Project - Snippet Three

By Ian Richter

There is still work to be completed on the chassis, little tweaks to remove the dents from the underside of the rails.

I am pulling these dents out to ensure the chassis is flat or close to what the chassis would have looked like 70 years back. It's a fair amount of work, but you only get one go at this before painting. I thought I was doing all right until Colin Rule, aka the wizard, dropped in to see how things were coming along. Colin drove up in his meticulously restored BN2, a thing of beauty. I am not sure if it was for encouragement or to depress me. I looked at his BN2 and then squinted at Maude slung between two ends of the rotisserie. With imagination and plenty of mental agility, yes, I think I can see where I am heading.



Armed with a piece of chalk and a straight edge, Colin proceeded to identify all my areas for improvement on the chassis; tough marker...but I certainly do appreciate his advice and expertise. There is a fairly major chassis adjustment required toward

the front of the car on the passenger side, hence the reason for the drop-in to discuss. The chassis rail has ballooned where it has taken an impact. "Pull the oxy out, and we will give it some heat," Colin said. The larger the flame, the broader his smile. The shed was filled with irritating acrid smoke from the chassis paint and years of hard old grease burning as the oxy-heating tip did its job. Colin was more concerned about not burning a hole in his good jumper than the tears in my eyes and a shed full of smoke you couldn't breathe in. The smoke haze in the shed brings me to a wonderful old book I picked up a few years back, which has absolutely nothing to do with Austin-Healeys at all.

I will quote, "The start was fixed for ten o'clock from the Hotel Metropole. I shall never forget the scene that met my eyes when I entered. French mechanics and German inventors with enthusiasts were mixed up in indescribable confusion. Huge flares were being carried about from one machine to another to assist in lighting up the burners for the cars, which at the time were innocent of electric ignition. An occasional petrol blaze was seen through the smoke fog which filled the hall, making the scene resemble a veritable inferno." Sounds a bit like Colin in my shed.



The book, *Ten Years of Motors and Motor Racing 1896-1906*, written by Charles Jarrott and first published in 1906, describes Charles's first-hand accounts of the earliest years of the motor car in the

Maude cont'

UK and Europe. The book begins on the 14th of November 1896 on a foggy, dull, wet typical UK November morning as Charles makes his way to watch the start of the "Emancipation Run from London to Brighton."

Prior to this date, vehicles on UK roads were restricted to a max speed of 4 mph but only when being led by a red flag waver 50 yards in front, warning other users on the road of the pending mechanical contraption following. Late in 1896, a change of government did away with the speed restrictions on cars, ditching the man-on-foot red flag waving stipulation and raising the speed limit to 12mph.

Charles goes on, "After enormous difficulty and strenuous effort on the part of everybody, much pushing and collisions, the cars made their way out of the hall towards the starting point... The scene at the Metropole was one never to be forgotten. It is said that a spectator often sees most of the game, and I confess what I saw on that morning did much to amuse me. The progress of the start was slow, and as I watched the cars slowly making their way to Westminster Bridge, I distinctly remember wondering if any of the party would come back alive. Of course, there were a number of wrecks left at the starting post and one of the last things I noticed was a French mechanic, who spoke not a word of English, stranded with his car, in misery and rage, and keeping off the crowd with the end of a particularly vicious and formidable looking starting handle."



The book continues with a fascinating insight into the beginning of the motorcar and particularly motorbike and motorcar racing. Charles Jarrott was

born in 1877 and originally planned to make the law his career, but gave this up for motoring. He started racing with a De Dion tricycle at the Crystal Palace cycle track and drove a Panhard, fitted with a prototype Napier engine, in the Thousand Mile Trial of 1900, to name a few of his exploits. (In case the Panhard car rings a bell, way back at the end of the 19th Century, parent company Panhard et Levassor developed the Panhard rod that stops the rear end from moving sideways. A Panhard rod is fitted to all Big Healeys except for the greater majority of BJ8s. PQ)

The forward leaps in speed and engine technology are described throughout the book. There is a small table on the last few pages, which is the record of ten years of motor racing. In 1896 the fastest racer was the Panhard, with its four horsepower engine scooting along with an average speed of 14 mph. Jump forward to 1906 and the of choice for the racer would have been the Darracq pumping out 120 hp with an average speed on the Circuit des Ardennes of 66 mph and topping out at 109 mph down the straits. Now that is bravery.

Enough of this distraction, I say. Not a lot happened to Maude this month. I have put the chassis on hold for the moment and started to cut out the sills and deal with the layers of previous rust repairs in the front of the rear inner quarter panel, where it meets what is left of the inner sill. The previous repairs completed were layer upon layer of metal on top of rusty metal, all carefully and neatly braised in. By whom? Nobody knows - but definitely an old school tradesman. It all gets cut back to good metal and a clean-up.



Maude cont'

This process along gives some self-satisfaction. The inner sill needs to be in place before completing the rear inner quarter panel repair. This will be the focus next month. Complete one side and then repeat on the other.



Until the next update. Ian

One last thing. There is a great little statement that Charles Jarrott wrote on the improved reliability of the 1898 motor car. "Motors reached a stage when a long journey could be undertaken with a reasonable amount of certainty that, in the course of time, one would reach a destination. It was not a certainty as to when one would arrive, but with perseverance and time at your disposal, the goal could eventually be reached." Sounds familiar to a few Austin-Healey runs I have undertaken. You eventually get to get there but they do take resolve.

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Can a Multimeter help me and my Austin-Healey?

By Chris Hatch

Many car enthusiasts love the sense of motoring and generally have a sound understanding and aptitude of the mechanical items in their cars. However, car electrics on the other hand can be seen by many owners as voodoo in nature (or magic just happens). And in the instance of the Mid North Coast Chapter of the AHOC NSW this is no different. With the discussion starting out along the lines of “I carry a spare rebuilt dizzy and leads wherever I go”, followed by “I can’t get a good condenser anymore.” and “Is every coil a 12volt coil and will it work in my car?” and “I don’t trust this electronic stuff, it’s crap.”. You can correctly assume where this conversation continued with a group of middle-aged men and a good strong brew of tea and coffee.

It was with a bit of trepidation that I thought, I would test how I fitted in to this well-oiled and fire breathing group of British motor vehicle loving people and blurted out “You can leave all that at home and just carry a multimeter with you and think of all the extra space you will have”.

Hmmm, the pause in the conversation was deafening and felt like it lasted a year, and when the response did

After reflecting on what was the basis of the broader discussion, understanding the individual components is a must, but first we really need to understand the multimeter as a tool to help breakdown the magic of electrical items in our cars. Thus, the first ever session of school was pencilled in for the Mid North Coast Chapter of the AHOC NSW for “How to use a Multimeter”.

The day of reckoning had arrived, and as I was heading down the freeway to the next Chapter meeting, I must confess, I did have the thought that this was an oppor-



tunity for the apprentice to become the master, but time would tell. Upon arrival I was surprised at the enthusiasm of those in attendance (while I was the last to arrive, I was on time) for what was a topic that can on occasions be not very exciting to the masses. Anyway, on my way to the shed and passing the back of the first car in the drive, the boot is opened and in the back is two full shopping bags of “car electrical stuff”. Well, what have I got myself into here?

First key learning for the potential master - focus, focus, focus. Don’t assume anything as those shopping bags full of English dizzys, leads, condensers, coils etc maybe on their way to the local recycling centre. So, into the Workshop we go, and our host Phil drops a little cracker, “I had a flat battery in the car, so I pulled it out yesterday to charge, but the electronic charger doesn’t work, and I had to borrow the old clunker charger from Al”. While everyone was setting up, and just like “Mr Gadget”, I pulled out my trusty multimeter.



occur, it was polite, but succinct in nature, “I think I will stick with what I know, thank you”. Luckily the balancing force was listening with interest, and with their support with key arguments of “Don’t you think this would help?” and “Would this make the car more reliable?” it was confirmed that we would look at coils and condensers at our next meeting, or so they thought.

Multimeter cont'

And just like bees to the honey pot, and before I could set up the multimeter the crowd had gathered. A quick check of the multimeter and on go the leads to measure the voltage on the battery terminals. No quicker than I had placed the leads on the battery terminals, than I removed the leads. Why???

“Gents, is this a test to see if I know my stuff”? A very emphatic response from the group was given, “No!”. Well, the multimeter has passed it first test as to why you should have and use one. The leads from the charger had been put on backwards (reverse polarity) and the multimeter was reading a negative 14



volts (-14.2v). After a little fiddling and rearranging stuff, the battery was set up to charge correctly with a hope of restoring its health. Noting that the newer style electronic charger was been bounced around and heading in the direction of the nearest garbage bin, a quick overview of how these devices work was given, and the electronic charger was connected to the battery identified above to show that it did and does indeed work.

As these modern electronic battery chargers' sense for a voltage when you connect, if the voltage on the battery is below a predetermined threshold (potentially 6-9v for a 12v charger), they will not output a charge. Using a multimeter to test the actual voltage on the battery will help in this situation. (Hint: if the battery voltage is low such that the electronic charger will not operate, you can trick these units into operation by applying 9+volts across the charger leads on the battery terminals and they will kick into operation).

With a pause in activities, the true width and breadth of what we were working with as a group became evident. Along with the already identified items of many coils, leads, dizzys, condensers, switches (battery isolation), there was also presented for the first time the trusty SU fuel pump in various forms. Where to really start? While many of us are just looking for the answer, the objective was to really open-up on what is a multimeter and how to use a multimeter.

First formal lesson was to run through the two general types of multimeters with the group, these being the “electronic type” and the older style “moving iron meter”, and the general pros and cons of each type. For what seems only a matter of minutes, we had successfully spent two hours with the many heads in a huddle looking at the multimeters.

As this was the first attempt at running school for a group of middle-aged men, I can confirm that the session was successful based from a comment of one participant to his wife when he was leaving the shed, “Yeah, I should have brought pen and paper to take notes”. There will be a cheat sheet developed to help understand how to use a multimeter (covering the what, the how and when of the functions) and what to look for if you are indeed intending on purchasing one to add to the toolkit.

On my return trip home, I did reflect on how successful our first session of school was, and whether the apprentice had indeed become the master in this well-oiled fired breathing group of British motor car owners, I would suggest the jury is still out on that one. Only more class time will tell.



Your Last Page



Spot the Austin-Healey

In amongst all that American plastic, there are a couple of Austin-Healeys

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Married American actors June Allyson and Dick Powell out for a drive in their Austin-Healey 100, May 1955

Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm